

JONATHAN KEEN

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EDUCATION

Arizona State University

Tempe, AZ

PhD in Finance, awarded May 2026

Dissertation Committee: Yuri Tserlukevich (chair), Denis Sosyura, George Aragon

Baylor University

Waco, TX

BBA in Finance and Economics, 2020

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Corporate Finance, Government Institutions, Innovation Economics, Investments

WORKING PAPERS

Job Market Paper: Government Efficiency in Facilitating Innovation

Solo-Authored

Abstract: I use the state-level retirements of federal contract officers as an exogenous shock to firm revenue to measure the sensitivity of private R&D investment to cash flow from government contracts. I find that turnover of a federal contract office predicts a \$24 million decrease in contract revenue the next period. Then, I estimate the causal impact of \$1 million in additional contract revenue and find that it increases firm R&D expense by a modest \$9,900. Finally, I explore the research outputs of this funding and find that government funding increases patent applications, but that these patents are of lower average quality. This suggests that the complementarity between federal funding and private sector innovation is limited in practice, and that researchers studying government contracting should pay close attention to endogeneity issues.

Investor Learning and Mutual Fund Performance

with Yuri Tserlukevich, George Aragon, and Mike Wymbs

Abstract: We extend Berk and Green's (2004) model by integrating Miller's (1977) insight on the effects of heterogeneous beliefs and restricted short sales, proposing that higher investor attention not only attracts optimistic inflows but also inflates assets under management and diminishes future fund performance. Using Abnormal View Share (AVS) - a novel measure of investor attention based on SEC EDGAR view data - we find that increased AVS predicts greater fund inflows in the following month but lower returns thereafter. This work underscores how limited attention and optimism impact fund valuations, advancing the intersection of investor attention and market dynamics theories.

Mergers and Acquisitions, Diversification, and Downside Risk

Solo-Authored

Abstract: I document that firms which diversify through mergers and acquisitions face increased downside risk in the short-term after the event. The returns of these "recent diversifiers" are significantly more sensitive to target industry downturns than those of their non-diversifying counterparts over the first five years post-event. Specifically, during downturns, as target industry return decreases by an additional 1pp, the return of recently diversified firms decreases by 1.80pp, while that of recent non-diversifiers decreases by 0.79pp, on average. This difference in sensitivity is not seen for downturns in the acquirer industry or for upturns in either industry, and becomes much smaller, on average, over years six through ten. This suggests that as firms diversify into a new industry, their inexperience in operating during downturns increases their downside risk in the short-term, but that this increased risk dissipates over time as they gain experience. This risk is unsystematic and thus has implications for the firm, but not well-diversified investors.

ACADEMIC PRESENTATIONS

2025: FMA Doctoral Consortium; NFA Annual Meeting

2024: ESMT Berlin Asset Management Conference; Baylor University

RESEARCH AWARDS

2022: Best PhD Summer Paper Award

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2024: Instructor, Advanced Managerial Finance (Advanced Core, Finance BA) mean evaluation: 6.70 / 7.00

TEACHING AWARDS

2024-2025: John W. Teets Outstanding Undergraduate Teaching Assistant Award

REFERENCES

Yuri Tserlukevich (chair)	Associate Professor of Finance, ASU	yuri.tserlukevich@asu.edu
George Aragon	Professor of Finance, ASU	george.aragon@asu.edu
Denis Sosyura	James and Elizabeth Robertseon Chair in Finance, ASU	denis.sosyura@asu.edu